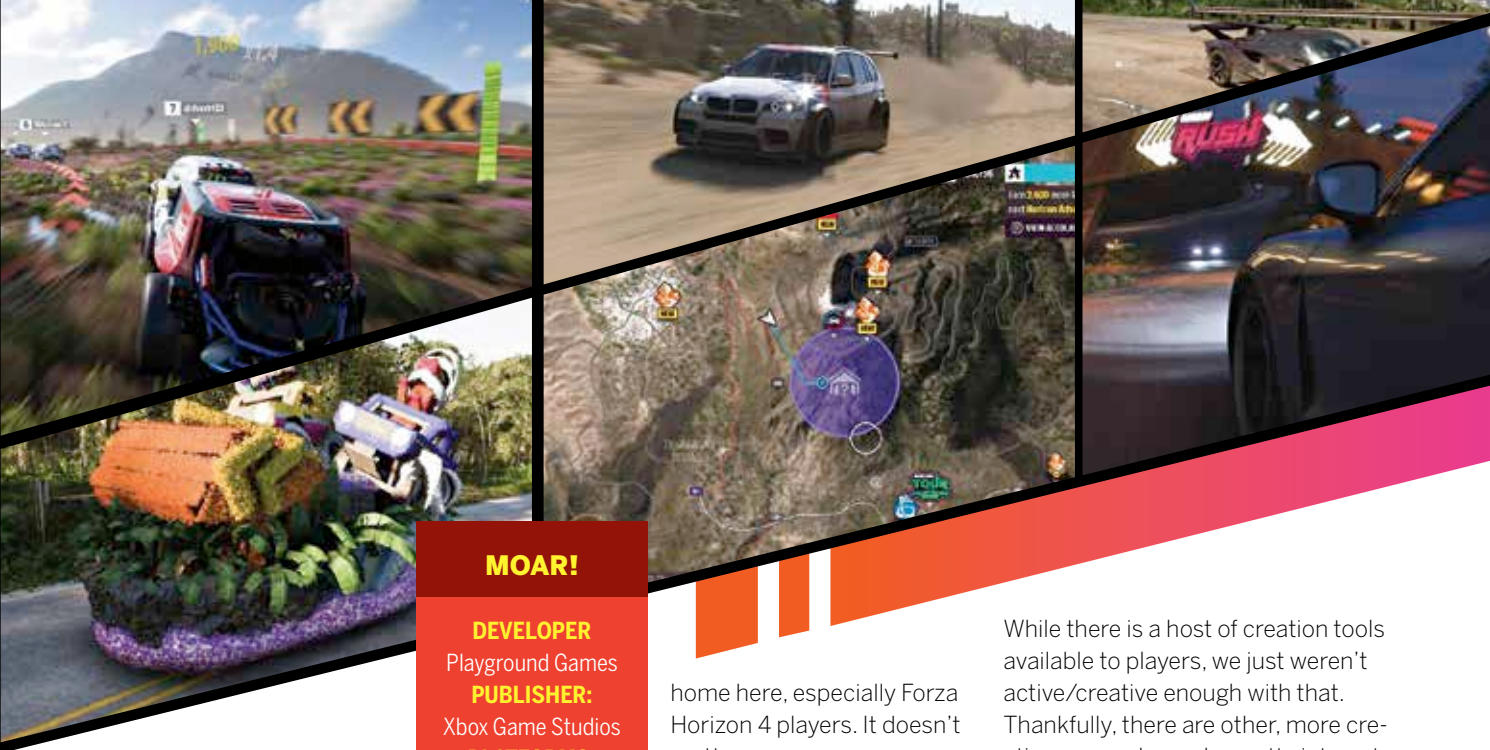




MOAR!

DEVELOPER

Playground Games

PUBLISHER:

Xbox Game Studios

PLATFORMS:

Xbox Series, Xbox Series S, Xbox One, Xbox One X and PC

REVIEWED ON:

Xbox Series X

PRICE:

₹3,499 (Steam),
₹3,999 (Microsoft Store), free for Xbox Game Pass subscribers

an in-depth story with twists and turns. It doesn't need it ***stares at the Need For Speed franchise***.

In Forza Horizon 5, you aren't a nobody trying to make a name for yourself. The game continues over from Forza Horizon 4 and as such, you are already a big name within the Horizon Festival. This is why ONLY YOU can help the in-game organisers set up the Festival and partake in the Showcase events. And you know what, that's fine! This gives players a great way to experience all that the map has to offer.

In Forza Horizon 5, your custom character isn't just a mute spectator in the proceedings. There's a lot more interaction with NPCs, both on and off the track. Thankfully, off-track interactions are usually brief, while on-track interactions are usually limited to radio chatter. So the focus remains on the racing at all times. Unfortunately, the voice options are limited to just male and female with a British accent. We would like to have more options in terms of accents, but maybe we will see that in a future update.

The basic gameplay in Forza Horizon 5 remains unchanged. In fact, former Forza players should feel right at

home here, especially Forza Horizon 4 players. It doesn't matter

if you like bombing through the jungle in rally racing or cutting through a city in street racing, there should be something that everyone should enjoy.

Forza Horizon's Showcase events also return, letting you race against some non-car competition.

There are over 500 cars in the game and this number will go up as more DLC

content is released in the future. These include everything from vintage classics, legendary supercars, retro rally monsters, finely tuned track day cars, modern hypercars and pretty much everything in between. Players can build up a sizable in-game garage through multiple means. As players progress, they can unlock Wheelspins that can give them a chance to win a ride, or they can bid on a car they like in the Auction House. If you're normal, you could just head over to the Autoshow and buy a car with your winnings. The series' staple of finding abandoned cars in barns returns, but this time, players can add a vehicle from their own collection for other players to find if they want. Players can also auction off any unwanted cars in the Auction House or customise them with paint jobs or tune them.

The EventsLab section of the game lets players create their own races.

While there is a host of creation tools available to players, we just weren't active/creative enough with that. Thankfully, there are other, more creative users who make pretty interesting racing. Like for example. There was one race created at the top of the mountain that challenged us to get to the bottom by basically driving off the mountain.

VERDICT

Forza Horizon 5 is a natural step up from Forza Horizon 4 and that's a good thing. The game takes whatever makes the latter awesome and cranked things up a notch. The map is bigger, and more diverse, which makes for very varied races. The icing on the cake is the fact that the graphics are awesome, which makes each locale that much better to drive through. It doesn't matter what type of racing you like, Forza Horizon 5 has something to offer to all. But the game is more important than the sum of its parts. The game is also the 'killer app' for the new Xbox Series X and Series S consoles. It is an 'exclusive' Microsoft desperately needed to compete with the likes of Spider-man: Miles Morales on the Sony PS5.

My only nitpicks would be the clunky UI and average soundtrack. But they don't take away from the best aspects of the game, which is the racing and beautiful setting. Forza Horizon 5 is a game that anyone can pick up and play. You don't have to be a Forza devotee to enjoy what the game has to offer, which is exactly what new buyers of the Xbox Series X/S would look for. *